5.3.1 Washing

Washing clothes is an important skill. Washing is one way of cleaning namely with water and often some kind of soap or detergent. It is an essential part of good hygiene and health. Getting clothes clean is not hard if the correct methods and laundry products are used.

5.3.1.1 Principles of Washing and their Applications

Home laundering is one of the most important and common household chores. Humans have developed many specialized methods for laundering, ranging from the earliest pound clothes against rocks in running stream to the latest in electronic washing machines and dry cleaning.

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The dirt which soils fabrics may be classified as

1. Loose dirt on the fibres.
2. Fixed dirt which is held fast by grease.

Loose dirt is removed in steeping and mechanical means such as brushing and shaking. Fixed dirt is removed by means of absorption, washing and dry cleaning.

5.3.1.2 Hand Washing

Hand washing is vital for clothes, fabric and dyes that cannot take the stress and strain of machine agitation and spin. It is very practical for a small wardrobe and is the best way to prolong the life of a piece of clothing.

Who invented the Washing Machine?

The earliest washing machine was the scrub board invented in 1747. American James King patented the first washing machine to use a drum in 1851. In 1858, Hamilton Smith patented the first rotary washing machine. It was a machine which removed and washed away dirt from clothes



The appropriate method for the treatment of dirt and kind of rubbing is given below:

Table 5.1 Method for the Treatment of dirt and kind of rubbing

Method of Washing		Process	Use
I. Friction Washing			
a.	Hand Friction	• Wring the article out of the steeping water. • Apply soap to the most soiled parts and rub until the dirt loosened. • Rinse out all soap with warm water	Suitable for cleaning much soiled small articles made of cotton or linen. Suitable for cleaning much soiled small articles made of cotton or linen.
b.	Friction by use of a scrubbing brush	• Wring the article out of the steeping water. • Spread on a flat surface and rub over with soap • Rinse out the soap in warm water.	Suitable for very soiled household articles of any coarse strong fabrics.

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